

Engineering College FAQs

A Comprehensive Guide for Students: Academics, Campus Life, and Placements

Section 1: Academics & Curriculum

1. What is the difference between SGPA and CGPA?

SGPA (Semester Grade Point Average) represents your academic performance in a single semester. CGPA (Cumulative Grade Point Average) is the overall average of your grades across all completed semesters.

2. How are credits calculated for different subjects?

Credits denote the weightage of a course. Typically, 1 hour of theory lecture per week equals 1 credit, while 2 hours of laboratory or practical work per week equals 1 credit. Core subjects usually carry more credits than labs.

3. What is an Open Elective?

An Open Elective is a subject chosen from a pool of courses offered by departments other than your core engineering branch (e.g., a Computer Science student taking a course in Financial Management or Psychology). It promotes interdisciplinary learning.

4. Can I change my engineering branch after the first year?

Yes, most institutions allow branch changes after the 1st year, strictly based on merit (1st-year CGPA) and seat availability in the desired branch. You typically need a CGPA above a specific threshold (e.g., 8.0 or 8.5) to be considered.

5. What is the role of a faculty advisor or mentor?

A faculty mentor guides you through your academic journey, helps you choose electives, monitors your attendance and performance, and provides support for career planning and personal development.

6. Are assignments and tutorials mandatory?

Yes, they form a significant part of your internal/continuous assessment marks. Skipping assignments can severely lower your sessional grades and affect your final SGPA.

7. What is a "Mass Bunk" and how does the college view it?

A mass bunk is when an entire class unanimously decides to skip a lecture. Colleges strictly prohibit this and usually penalize students by deducting attendance, imposing fines, or conducting surprise tests.

8. What happens if I fail a subject?

Failing a subject results in a "backlog" (or "KT" - Keep Term). You must clear this backlog in subsequent semesters by appearing for compartmental/supplementary exams as per the university schedule.

Section 2: Examinations & Attendance

9. What is the minimum attendance requirement?

As per standard university and AICTE norms, a minimum of 75% attendance in theory and practical classes separately is mandatory to be eligible to sit for the end-semester examinations.

10. Can I get medical leave if I fall short of attendance?

If your attendance is between 65% and 75%, medical leave may be considered if you submit a valid medical certificate from a registered practitioner immediately upon returning to college. Relaxation below 65% is generally not permitted.

11. What is the difference between Mid-Term (Sessional) and End-Term exams?

Mid-terms are internal exams conducted by the college midway through the semester to assess ongoing progress. End-term exams are comprehensive final exams conducted at the end of the semester, usually carrying 60-70% of the total course weightage.

12. What constitutes academic malpractice or UFM?

Unfair Means (UFM) includes carrying unauthorized notes, copying from others, using smart devices, or communicating during exams. Consequences range from cancellation of the specific paper to rustication for the entire semester.

13. Is there a provision for re-evaluation if I am unhappy with my marks?

Yes, most universities offer a re-evaluation or re-totaling window shortly after results are declared. Students must apply and pay a nominal fee per subject within the stipulated deadline.

14. What is a "Year Back"?

If a student fails to clear a minimum number of required credits (varies by university) at the end of an academic year, they are not promoted to the next year and must repeat the current year. This is called a Year Back.

Section 3: Internships, Projects & Placements

15. When do campus placements usually begin?

Campus placements typically begin in the 7th semester (the start of the 4th year). However, preparations, mock interviews, and aptitude training generally start from the 5th semester onwards.

16. Does having a backlog affect my placement chances?

Yes, many top-tier and core companies require a "clear record" with no active backlogs at the time of the interview. Some companies also stipulate a criteria of no history of backlogs at all.

17. Are summer internships mandatory?

Yes, AICTE guidelines mandate industrial training or internships (usually 4 to 6 weeks) at the end of the 2nd and 3rd years. These carry academic credits and require the submission of a formal report.

18. What is a NOC for an internship?

A No Objection Certificate (NOC) is an official document issued by the college stating that they have no objection to you interning at a specific company during your academic term or vacation.

19. What is the difference between On-Campus and Off-Campus placements?

On-Campus placements are facilitated by the college's Placement Cell, where companies visit the institute. Off-Campus placements require students to independently apply to companies directly or participate in external recruitment drives.

20. What is a "Major Project"?

The Major Project is a final-year curriculum requirement where students work in teams to design, develop, and present an engineering solution or research work. It heavily impacts the 8th-semester SGPA.

21. Can I opt out of placements to pursue higher studies?

Yes, students planning for GATE, GRE, CAT, or other higher studies can officially opt out of the placement process by notifying the Training & Placement (T&P) cell.

Section 4: Campus Life & Facilities

22. What are technical and cultural clubs?

Clubs are student-run organizations focusing on specific interests (e.g., Robotics Club, Coding Society, Drama Club, Dance Troupe). They help in skill development, networking, and stress relief.

23. How do I issue books from the central library?

Students use their college ID card to issue books. Typically, you can issue 3-5 books for a period of 14-21 days, after which a late fine is charged if not renewed or returned.

24. Is the campus Wi-Fi accessible to all students?

Yes, campus Wi-Fi is generally available in academic blocks, libraries, and hostels. However, it often requires a unique student login, and access to entertainment or non-academic sites may be firewalled.

25. What is the Anti-Ragging policy?

Ragging is a criminal offense. All engineering colleges adhere strictly to UGC/AICTE anti-ragging regulations. Any form of physical, mental, or emotional harassment can lead to immediate rustication and police action.

26. Are medical facilities available on campus?

Most campuses have an internal dispensary or health center with a visiting doctor and basic first aid. For emergencies, colleges usually have tie-ups with nearby multi-specialty hospitals and an ambulance on standby.

27. What is an Outpass?

For students residing in college hostels, an outpass is written or digital permission required from the hostel warden to leave the campus premises during specific hours or for a weekend trip home.

Section 5: General Administration

28. What is the procedure if I lose my college ID card?

You must immediately report the loss to the college administration and file a formal request/FIR if necessary. A duplicate ID will be issued upon payment of a specific penalty fee.

29. Is there a specific dress code on campus?

While many colleges do not have uniforms, a "smart casual" dress code is expected. However, for workshops, labs, and official presentations, formal attire and closed-toe shoes are strictly mandatory for safety and professionalism.

30. How can I get a Letter of Recommendation (LOR) for higher studies?

You should approach professors who have taught you core subjects or guided your projects. Provide them with your resume and statement of purpose, giving them ample time (usually 3-4 weeks) to draft and submit the LOR.

31. What are the common modes of fee payment?

Institutions generally accept semester fees via online payment gateways (Net Banking, UPI, Credit/Debit cards) through the student portal, or via Demand Drafts (DD). Cash payments for large amounts are rarely accepted.

32. How can I apply for scholarships?

Information about state, central, and institute-level merit or category-based scholarships is usually circulated by the college's administrative office. You must apply through official portals (like the National Scholarship Portal) with valid income and caste certificates.

33. Can day scholars use the hostel mess facilities?

Usually, day scholars are not allowed in the hostel mess to avoid overcrowding. However, some colleges offer a paid "lunch-only" subscription or have separate campus canteens/cafeterias for all students.

34. What is the Grievance Redressal Cell?

It is an official committee formed to address and resolve student complaints regarding academics, administration, or harassment. Students can submit written applications or use the college's online portal to file a grievance anonymously.

35. Are parents informed about academic progress and attendance?

Yes, most modern engineering colleges have a Parent Portal or send automated SMS/Email updates regarding mid-term marks, short attendance, and disciplinary issues.